Gamification and student motivation

Field: Education | Years: 2021-2026 | 4 papers

#	Title	Author(s) & Year	Quartile	Method	Access	Introduction	Methodology	Results	Discussion	Theoretical Framework
1	Gamified quizzes and intrinsic motivation among Malaysian undergraduates doi:10.1/a	Tan & Rahman (2023)	Unranked/ Unavailable	Quantitative	Unclear	Asks whether using gamified quizzes raises undergraduates' intrinsic motivation.	Cross-sectional survey of 320 undergraduates at two Malaysian public universities; analysed with PLS-SEM.	Gamified quiz use was a significant positive predictor of intrinsic motivation (beta = 0.38, p < .001).	Reads the finding as support for SDT; advises designing quizzes that support student autonomy.	Self-Determination Theory
2	Leaderboards in secondary science classrooms doi:10.1/b	Lee (2022)	Unranked/ Unavailable	Quantitative	Unclear	Tests how leaderboards affect pupil engagement in science lessons.	Quasi-experiment with 140 secondary pupils in Penang over 8 weeks.	Not retrieved (results section missing from the available copy).	Warns that leaderboards may lower motivation among low-performing pupils.	Not explicitly stated
3	Students' lived experience of gamified learning	Ali & Wong (2024)	N/A (thesis/ preprint/ conference)	Qualitative	Unclear	Explores how students experience courses that use gamification (PhD thesis, Universiti Example).	Interviews with 18 students; thematic analysis.	Identified three themes: competition, autonomy and fatigue.	Reports that gamification fatigue sets in after about week 6 of a course.	Flow Theory
4	Badges and engagement in MOOCs: a review doi:10.1/d	Ali (2021)	Unranked/ Unavailable	Theoretical/ Review	Unclear	Reviews the evidence on digital badges and learner engagement in MOOCs.	Narrative review of 40 studies.	24 of the 40 studies tied badges to short-term gains in course completion.	Concludes that long-term effects of badges remain unclear.	Goal-Setting Theory

Synthesis

Each of the four papers rests on a different lens (Self-Determination Theory, Flow Theory, Goal-Setting Theory, and one with no stated framework), so there is no shared theoretical base yet; SDT is the only one tested directly against motivation. Methods are mixed: two quantitative studies (a cross-sectional PLS-SEM survey and a quasi-experiment), one qualitative interview thesis and one narrative review, with no mixed-methods or longitudinal design. The quartile balance is weak: none of the three journals could be found in Scimago (SJR), so all three are Unranked/Unavailable, and the fourth item is a PhD thesis; consider adding Q1/Q2 Education journal articles before relying on this set. Recurring signals are that gamification effects may be short-lived (badge gains are short-term; fatigue appears around week 6) and can backfire for some learners (leaderboards and low performers). Gaps your study could fill: a longitudinal or multi-wave test of whether gamification's effect on intrinsic motivation persists, a test of SDT-based autonomy-supportive designs against competitive elements, and results for the Penang leaderboard study, which could not be recorded from the available copy. Note that two items share an author (Ali, 2021 and Ali & Wong, 2024).